What Do You Know About Dad's House and Savings, and What Are You Guessing?

A twelve-question check. At the end: what you know, what's still unclear, and what to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure. This checks how complete your picture is of what Dad owns and whose name is on it. It doesn't measure his finances, and no answer here says how anything would be treated or whether he would be eligible for anything.

1. Do you have a written, dated list of what Dad owns: the home, savings, investments, retirement accounts, insurance and anything else of value?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. Have you seen the deed to Dad's home, and do you know whose name is on it?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. For each account, do you know whose name is on it and whether it's held jointly with anyone?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. Do you know who is named as beneficiary on each retirement account, insurance policy and annuity, from a form or a statement?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. Do you know where the papers are kept: the deed, the statements, the policies, the beneficiary forms and any trust papers?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. Have you written down who lives in Dad's home and, if he's married, what is in his spouse's name?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. Have you heard from Dad, in his own words, what he'd want for the house and his savings?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. Have you written down any changes the family has talked about, such as adding a name to an account or changing the deed?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. Have you written down your legal questions, including what estate recovery is and how it works in Dad's state?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Have you written down your financial questions about his retirement accounts, insurance and annuities?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. Has the family agreed on what would send you back to the list, such as a change in Dad's health, a move or a sale of property?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. For each open question, do you know which kind of professional you'd take it to?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT YOU KNOW

WHAT'S STILL UNCLEAR

QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY

What this doesn't do

It counts what you know and have in hand, not what Dad owns and not how any of it would be treated. A low count means there are things to look up, and most of them are a statement, a form or a conversation with Dad away. The questions on your page go to a professional who knows Dad's state, because the rules vary by state and change. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You can see what you know about what Dad owns, what you're guessing and what you'd need to ask. The planning interview asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care. Keep the page you just copied beside you while you answer.

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